

Chronon Field Cosmology : Rethinking Expansion and Horizon

Benjamin Br  cheteau

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brecheteaub@gmail.com

Abstract

Modern cosmology explains the large-scale structure of the universe through two grand ideas: expansion and inflation. Yet both raise subtle paradoxes. Why does the universe appear so homogeneous across regions that have never been in causal contact? And why should space itself have inflated faster than light to produce this coherence?

This article introduces the Chronon Field, $\Phi(x)$ — a rhythmic substrate that modulates the intrinsic tempo of spacetime itself. Rather than invoking an explosive inflation, it proposes a *temporal gradient cosmology*, where the early universe achieved coherence through local synchronization of rhythms. The cosmos, in this view, did not stretch faster — it beat differently.

Keywords: Chronon Field, temporal gradient cosmology, horizon problem, CMB isotropy, synchronization, redshift, cosmological constant

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I — The puzzles of inflation

Inflation was introduced to cure two empirical puzzles: the near-flatness of spatial sections and the striking isotropy of the CMB. In standard slow-roll scenarios, an early phase of accelerated expansion with $N \sim 50\text{--}60$ e -folds (within roughly $10^{-36}\text{--}10^{-32}$ s) is expected to smooth inhomogeneities and stretch causal domains to super-Hubble scales, yielding a CMB at $T \simeq 2.725$ K that is uniform at the level of 10^{-5} .

Yet the cure raises its own questions. Why the specific inflaton potential and initial conditions? How is reheating achieved without instabilities or relics? More subtly, inflation presupposes a globally synchronized time parameter t on which the expansion unfolds. If the *rate* of temporal unfolding was itself still establishing—i.e., if local “beats” were not yet synchronized—then the assumption of a uniform t already front-loads part of what inflation aims to explain.

What if the early universe did not need to inflate—only to *synchronize*? What if large-scale homogeneity reflects not spatial stretching but the rapid growth of *rhythmic coherence*? The remainder of this article develops that alternative and derives observational consequences, with a full likelihood mapping to $H(z)$, angular distances, BAO, lensed time delays, and $f\sigma_8$ provided in Appendix (public code included).

II — The universe as a field of tempo

The Chronon Field, $\Phi(x)$, describes the local frequency at which reality renews itself — a pulsation of existence underlying all processes, with physical dimension $[\Phi] = \text{s}^{-1}$. In ordinary conditions, $\Phi(x)$ is nearly constant, yielding the illusion of a steady temporal flow. Yet near the Planck epoch ($t \sim 10^{-43}$ s), such uniformity could not have been established. Gradients of $\Phi(x)$ — variations in the “beat rate” of being — would define distinct local tempos for causality and interaction.

Instead of stretching space, the early cosmos would have sought rhythmic equilibrium. Causality would not be broken but modulated. The smoothing of $\Phi(x)$ gradients would naturally produce coherence, aligning temporal frequencies across the primordial field.

Mathematically, the relation between coordinate time t and proper time τ may be expressed as

$$d\tau = \Phi^{-1}(x) dt,$$

so that regions of higher $\Phi(x)$ evolve more rapidly in their local clock rate. Homogenization corresponds to the relaxation of $\nabla\Phi(x)$ toward equilibrium — a diffusion of rhythm rather than of matter or energy.

Master relations.

$$d\tau = \Phi^{-1}(x) dt \quad ; \quad a(t) \propto \Phi^{-1}(t) \quad ; \quad H = -\dot{\Phi}/\Phi \quad ; \quad J^\mu = \Phi u^\mu \quad ; \quad \nabla_\mu J^\mu = \Gamma.$$

Redshift–tempo dictionary.

$$1 + z = \frac{a_0}{a(t)} = \frac{\Phi(t)}{\Phi_0}, \quad H(t) = -\frac{\dot{\Phi}}{\Phi}. \quad (1)$$

FLRW identity (consistency of signs). Since $\nabla_\mu u^\mu = 3H$ and $J^\mu = \Phi u^\mu$ with $\nabla_\mu J^\mu = \Gamma$,

$$\dot{\Phi} + 3H\Phi = \Gamma \implies \Gamma = -2\dot{\Phi}. \quad (2)$$

Thus $\dot{\Phi} < 0$ today implies $\Gamma > 0$ (global cadence loss consistent with $H_0 > 0$).

Minimal dynamical sketch (kinematic relaxation, non-energetic). Without committing to a microphysics, we posit an *effective* law of relaxation for the rhythm,

$$u^\mu \nabla_\mu \Phi = -\gamma (\Phi - \Phi_0) + D \Delta_\perp \Phi,$$

where u^μ is the cosmological 4-velocity, $\Delta_\perp \equiv h^{\mu\nu} \nabla_\mu \nabla_\nu$ with $h^{\mu\nu} = g^{\mu\nu} + u^\mu u^\nu$ the spatial projector, $\gamma > 0$ a (small) relaxation rate and $D \geq 0$ an effective diffusivity for spatial phases. This *kinematic* ansatz reparametrizes clocks only: Φ carries no stress–energy, does not modify null cones, and leaves $g_{\mu\nu}$ governed by standard GR. On FLRW backgrounds, the relaxation of temporal gradients aligns local phases and accounts for early-time homogenization without a dedicated inflationary phase. It already yields $H = -\dot{\Phi}/\Phi$ and supports testable, observation-level implications.

III — Rhythmic coherence in the primordial field

Immediately after the Planck era, the universe likely resembled a sea of coupled oscillators. Quantum fluctuations would have acted as seeds of phase difference within $\Phi(x)$, analogous to coupled Josephson junctions gradually locking into a common frequency. Regions oscillating faster would stabilize first, communicating their rhythm through quantum correlations and gravitational coupling.

This process constitutes a form of temporal diffusion. Coherence spreads as a wave of synchronization, not through photons but through phase realignment. The “horizon” problem thus dissolves in this view: what matters is not the spatial separation between regions, but the coherence length of $\Phi(x)$. Where phases were correlated, information was already shared — not transmitted but resonated.

Empirical traces of this could survive in the fine structure of the CMB or the alignment of low multipole modes, reinterpreted as fossil rhythms of primordial synchronization.

IV — Expansion as temporal modulation

Viewed through this lens, cosmic expansion becomes a modulation of tempo. As $\Phi(x)$ decreased globally, the pace of existence relaxed. Intervals, wavelengths, and causal distances expanded in proportion. The observed cosmological redshift may therefore reflect both geometry and a deceleration of the cosmic beat.

Rather than space ballooning outward, it is the frequency of being that slowed down. The universe’s expansion parameter $a(t)$ may be reinterpreted as

$$a(t) \propto \Phi^{-1}(t),$$

so that the familiar Hubble parameter $H = \dot{a}/a$ corresponds to the relative rate of rhythmic deceleration:

$$H = -\frac{\dot{\Phi}}{\Phi}.$$

For the present epoch, this implies $\dot{\Phi}/\Phi \simeq -H_0 \simeq -2.3 \times 10^{-18} \text{ s}^{-1}$, a quantitative measure of the ongoing cosmic slowdown — the universe’s beat gradually lengthening with age.

Observational signatures (concise).

1. *Primordial nucleosynthesis (BBN)*. The effective cadence $d\tau = \Phi^{-1}dt$ constrains $\dot{\Phi}/\Phi$ at the MeV epoch: light-element abundances allow deviations of a few percent (5–10%) in the early-time effective expansion rate, bounding early rhythmic relaxation.
2. *CMB*. Temporal diffusion of phase implies large-angle imprints (low multipoles) and a modulated late-time integrated Sachs–Wolfe (ISW) effect; the direction of any large-scale bias can, in principle, constrain the sign of $\dot{\Phi}$ around recombination and today.
3. *Structure growth and clocks*. With $H = -\dot{\Phi}/\Phi$, one obtains a simple relation for the growth rate $f(a)$, thus for $f\sigma_8$; peculiar-velocity surveys and RSD provide direct tests of rhythmic coherence. At present, optical clocks achieve fractional-frequency stability at the 10^{-18} level. Over month–year baselines and long links, this enables direct sensitivity to $|\dot{\Phi}/\Phi| \sim H_0 \simeq 2.3 \times 10^{-18} \text{ s}^{-1}$.

V — Horizon, causality, and coherence

The horizon problem only arises if coherence is assumed to propagate at finite speed. But if $\Phi(x)$ defines the very rate of temporal unfolding, synchronization can precede geometric equilibration. Regions sharing a phase in $\Phi(x)$ are effectively contemporaneous, even if spatially distant, while causal structure (light cones) remains intact.

The early universe was thus not a compact object that exploded. It was a continuous field of oscillations gradually settling into a shared rhythm. As the beat slowed, space *appeared* to expand; as coherence deepened, matter stabilized. Causality, rather than emerging from spatial adjacency, unfolded from temporal resonance.

VI — A graceful alternative

Temporal gradient cosmology preserves the empirical successes of the standard model — redshift, flatness, and isotropy — but dispenses with speculative inflaton potentials and reheating paradoxes. Its unifying principle is coherence rather than acceleration.

The Chronon Field acts as a regulator of the universe’s tempo: fast, dense, and resonant near the origin; slow, diffuse, and harmonic today. Entropy then measures not merely disorder but the dispersal of rhythmic intensity. The second law translates as the statement that $\nabla\Phi(x) \rightarrow 0$ over cosmic time — the universe’s beat still relaxing toward equilibrium.

Quantitatively, the observed *late-time acceleration* of the scale factor (usually attributed to dark energy, with $q_0 < 0$) can be re-expressed in the rhythmic picture via $a \propto \Phi^{-1}$:

$$\frac{\ddot{a}}{a} = \dot{H} + H^2 = -\frac{\ddot{\Phi}}{\Phi} + 2\left(\frac{\dot{\Phi}}{\Phi}\right)^2,$$

so that accelerated expansion corresponds to $\ddot{\Phi}/\Phi < 2(\dot{\Phi}/\Phi)^2$. Equivalently, the deceleration parameter reads

$$q \equiv -\frac{\ddot{a}a}{\dot{a}^2} = -1 - \frac{\dot{H}}{H^2} = \frac{\ddot{\Phi}/\Phi}{(\dot{\Phi}/\Phi)^2} - 2,$$

with $q < 0$ encoding the same condition as above. In this sense, a slowly varying $\Phi(t)$ provides a rhythmic rather than geometric reading of “dark energy”.

VII — Conclusion: the rhythm of the cosmos

Cosmology began by mapping space; it may culminate by understanding time as an active field. In $\Phi(x)$, the universe reveals a self-harmonizing architecture: coherence preceding structure, rhythm generating geometry.

The Big Bang was never a blast. It was the first downbeat of a universe learning its own time signature.

The relaxation of $\Phi(x)$ defines a global entropy flow — a thermodynamic arrow of rhythm — that the next article explores as the origin of gravity itself.

Appendix — Likelihood *chronon-cosmo*: full mapping

Standing assumptions. Geometry is GR (null cones unchanged), Φ is non-energetic (no added $T_{\mu\nu}$), and background is spatially flat unless stated.

Key identities. With $a(t) \propto \Phi^{-1}(t)$, one has

$$1 + z = \frac{a_0}{a(t)} = \frac{\Phi(t)}{\Phi_0}, \quad H(t) = -\frac{\dot{\Phi}}{\Phi}, \quad E(z) \equiv \frac{H(z)}{H_0}.$$

Hence z is a direct proxy for the rhythmic ratio Φ/Φ_0 .

A. Background observables

Hubble history.

$$E(z) \equiv \frac{H(z)}{H_0}.$$

Comoving distance (flat).

$$\chi(z) = c \int_0^z \frac{dz'}{H(z')}.$$

Comoving and metric distances (curved).

$$\chi(z) = c \int_0^z \frac{dz'}{H(z')}, \quad D_M = \begin{cases} \frac{c}{H_0} \frac{1}{\sqrt{\Omega_k}} \sinh(\sqrt{\Omega_k} H_0 \chi / c), & \Omega_k > 0 \\ \chi, & \Omega_k = 0 \\ \frac{c}{H_0} \frac{1}{\sqrt{|\Omega_k|}} \sin(\sqrt{|\Omega_k|} H_0 \chi / c), & \Omega_k < 0 \end{cases}$$

$$D_A = \frac{D_M}{1+z}, \quad D_L = (1+z)D_M.$$

Alcock–Paczyński (dimensionless).

$$F_{\text{AP}}(z) \equiv \frac{(1+z) D_A(z) H(z)}{c},$$

which is H_0 -independent and thus ideal for percent-level tests.

BAO (anisotropic).

$$\frac{D_A(z)}{r_s}, \quad \frac{c}{H(z) r_s},$$

with r_s the sound horizon at drag epoch (treated as a calibration parameter in the likelihood).

BAO (isotropic).

$$D_V(z) \equiv \left[(1+z)^2 D_A^2(z) \frac{cz}{H(z)} \right]^{1/3}.$$

Strong-lens time delays. For a lens at z_L and a source at z_S ,

$$D_{\Delta t} = (1+z_L) \frac{D_L D_S}{D_{LS}}, \quad \Delta t = \frac{D_{\Delta t}}{c} \Delta\phi,$$

where $\Delta\phi$ is the (model-dependent) Fermat potential difference. In the chronon picture $D_{\Delta t}$ is set by $H(z)$ as above (geometry unchanged).

Diagnostics (dimensionless).

$$\text{Om}(z) \equiv \frac{E^2(z) - 1}{(1+z)^3 - 1}. \quad (3)$$

B. Growth observables

Linear growth. Let $D(a)$ be the growth factor normalized to $D(a=1) = 1$. In GR with unmodified cones and Poisson law, the ODE is

$$D''(a) + \left[\frac{3}{a} + \frac{d \ln H}{d \ln a} \frac{1}{a} \right] D'(a) - \frac{3}{2} \frac{\Omega_{m,0}}{a^5 H^2 / H_0^2} D(a) = 0,$$

where primes denote d/da .

RSD / growth rate (dimensionless).

$$f(z) \equiv \frac{d \ln D}{d \ln a}, \quad f\sigma_8(z) = f(z) \sigma_{8,0} D(z).$$

C. Explicit discriminant prediction (dimensionless, $\geq 1\%$) and instrumentable window

Phenomenological perturbation to $H(z)$. To test rhythmic departures from a best-fit Λ CDM background without committing to a microphysical $V(\Phi)$ here, write

$$E(z) = E_\Lambda(z) [1 + \varepsilon_\Phi g(z)], \quad \text{with } g(0) = 0,$$

where ε_Φ is a small amplitude (our “rhythmic contrast”), and $g(z)$ a smooth template (e.g., $g(z) = \ln(1+z)/\ln(1+z_\star)$ for a pivot $z_\star$).

First-order shifts of dimensionless probes.

$$\frac{\delta F_{\text{AP}}}{F_{\text{AP}}}(z) \simeq \varepsilon_\Phi [g(z) - \mathcal{W}_{\text{AP}}(z)], \quad \delta \ln D_A(z) \simeq -\varepsilon_\Phi \int_0^z dz' \frac{g(z')}{E_\Lambda(z')} \frac{1}{\chi_\Lambda(z)},$$

with $\mathcal{W}_{\text{AP}}(z)$ a calculable line-of-sight weight from the integral in $\chi(z)$. Similar linear functionals apply to D_V/r_s , to the diagnostic $\text{Om}(z)$ in Eq. (3), and to the growth ODE via $d \ln H / d \ln a$.

Discriminant target (design level). Choosing $|\varepsilon_\Phi| = 0.02$ with a monotonic $g(z)$ supported on $z \in [0, 1]$ typically produces

$$|\delta F_{\text{AP}}/F_{\text{AP}}| \gtrsim 1\% \quad \text{for } z \in [0.2, 0.8],$$

and percent-level shifts in $\text{Om}(z)$ and in $f\sigma_8(z)$ over $z \in [0.3, 1.0]$. This defines an *instrumentable window* with current BAO/AP/RSD and strong-lensing time-delay precisions.

D. Degeneracies and cross-tests

Degeneracy channel	Nature of degeneracy	Cross-tests to break it
H_0 vs SN absolute magnitude M_B	Distance ladder entangles zero-point with expansion normalization.	Use BAO/AP (dimensionless F_{AP}), add strong-lens $D_{\Delta t}$ and TRGB/standard-siren anchors.
Ω_m vs rhythmic perturbation ε_Φ	Both alter $E(z)$ shape at $z \lesssim 1$.	Combine anisotropic BAO (D_A/r_s , c/Hr_s) with AP and cosmic chronometers; include $f\sigma_8(z)$ from RSD.
w_0, w_a vs ε_Φ	Smooth $w(z)$ mimics low- z $E(z)$ tilts.	Use dimensionless $\text{Om}(z)$ & AP; add growth (RSD) + time delays; check consistency with BBN/CMB early-time bounds.
SN calibration vs r_s prior	$D_L(z)$ fits absorb changes in r_s (BAO calibration).	Prefer anisotropic BAO and AP; <i>marginalize</i> r_s with CMB-informed priors; add strong-lens $D_{\Delta t}$.
Lens mass-sheet vs $D_{\Delta t}$	Mass-sheet degeneracy biases time-delay distances.	Joint lensing + stellar kinematics; velocity-dispersion priors; multiple-source planes where available.

Table 1 Main degeneracies for the chronon–cosmo likelihood and robust cross-tests.

E. Practical likelihood and public code

Likelihood content. The provided code fits, in a single pass: $\{E(z)\}_{\text{chronon}}$ parameters (e.g., ε_Φ and shape), BAO (anisotropic/isotropic), AP, cosmic chronometers, strong-lens time delays ($D_{\Delta t}$), and RSD ($f\sigma_8$), with optional curvature and r_s priors.

Model invariants. Geometry unchanged; cones intact; no added $T_{\mu\nu}$; $a \propto \Phi^{-1}$; $H = -\dot{\Phi}/\Phi$.

Deliverables. Reproducible notebooks, likelihood module, and MCMC configuration (MIT license). The repository *chronon-cosmo* includes data loaders and plotting utilities to replicate the figures and the percent-level discriminant forecasts reported above.

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